MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CURING UNIT, DENTURE, ONE STAGE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a one stage, automatically-controlled processing unit for curing dental acrylic resins used in the fabrication of dentures and other dental restorations and appliances.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-N-281	- Nickel-Copper Alloy, Forgings, Plates, Rods, Shapes, Sheets, Strips, and Wire.
PPP-B-585	- Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-L-10547	- Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6520

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-66 - Steel, Chemical Composition and Hardenability.
FED-STD-151 - Metals, Test Methods.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE (ANSI).

C73.11 - Plugs and Receptacles, General Purpose, 125 Volts, 15 Amperes, 2-Pole, 3-Wire, Grounding Type.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

UNDERWRITERS' LABORATORIES (UL)

UL-1262 - Standards for Safety, Laboratory Equipment.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., 1285 Walt Whitman Road, Melville, LI, NY 11746; 207 East Ohio Street, Chicago, IL 60611; or 1655 Scott Blvd., Santa Clara, CA 95050.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the procurement document, the contractor shall furnish sample unit(s) for first article inspection and approval (see 4.1.2.1 and 6.3).

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3.2 Fire and casualty hazards.

3.2.1 The contractor shall submit proof, prior to delivery, that the items to be delivered under the contract conform to the applicable requirements of Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc. (UL) Standard of Safety No. 1262. Proof shall consist of one of the following:

A. UL label affixed to the product, provided the contractor agrees to have Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc. forward a copy of the UL report directly to the Contracting Officer, upon the latter's request.

B. Laboratory report from a nationally recognized independent laboratory. If an independent laboratory is used, it must be adequately equipped and competent to determine compliance with UL standards. The Government reserves the right to require a facilities report and to conduct a facilities survey. Any laboratory report submitted shall include actual test methods, data taken, and results of tests. Detailed findings of examinations necessary to determine compliance shall also be included. The test report shall also have a section that describes the test sample in such a way that the report can be used to insure identity of production items with the test sample. This section shall be supplemented with construction information such as materials used, spacings between electrical components, types of bushings, photographs, wiring diagrams, sketches, and parts list, all appropriately identified. Compliance with this paragraph does not excuse compliance with all other requirements of the contract and specifications.

3.3 Materials. Materials shall conform to the applicable specifications and requirements specified herein. Materials not specifically designated shall be high commercial quality throughout, and shall be entirely suitable for the intended purpose.

3.3.1 Nickel-copper alloy. The nickel-copper alloy shall conform to QQ-N-281, class A.

3.3.2 Corrosion-resistant steel. Corrosion-resistant steel shall conform to the chemical composition for AISI types 202, 302 or 304 per FED-STD-66.

3.4 Design. The curing unit shall be a single stage, automatically controlled unit. The unit shall essentially consist of an enclosure housing, a tank, a tank cover with a suitable handle, an electrically heated element, a power switch, a pilot light, an electrical timer of the synchronous motor type, a strut type thermostat with calibrated temperature setting dial, and a thermal protection cut-off device. The tank shall be removable and of such size as to accommodate two standard denture flasks held in a two flask press for curing purposes. All controls, switches and pilot lights shall be mounted on the front control panel. The unit shall operate on a 115 ± 5 volts, 60 Hertz single phase alternating current. The power consumption shall be 350 watts ± 10%.

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3.5 Construction.

3.5.1 Dimensions. The curing unit shall have the following overall dimensions, excluding feet, with the cover in the inverted position: 12-1/2 ± 1/2 inches deep, 8-3/4 ± 1/2 inches wide, and 9-1/2 ± 1/2 inches high (see figure 1).

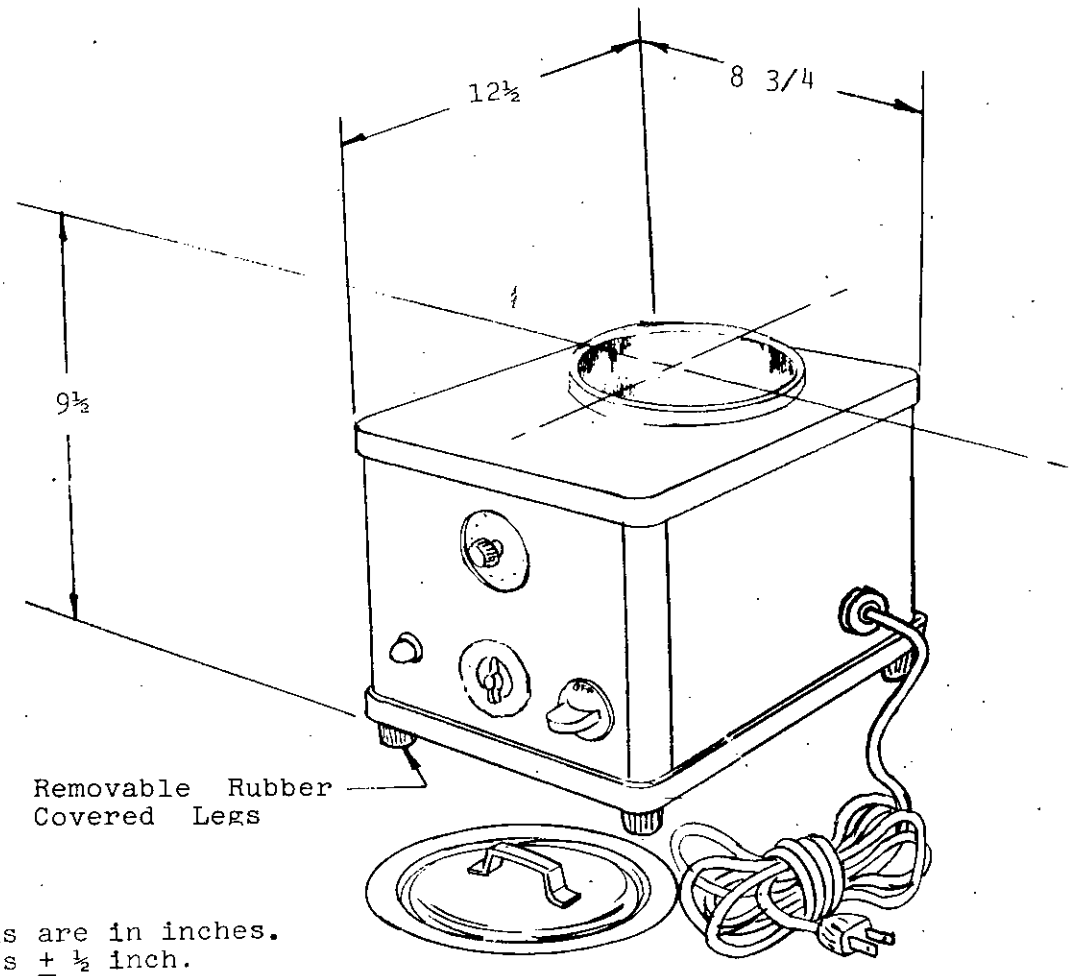
3.5.2 Enclosure housing. The enclosure housing shall consist of a U-shaped, wrap-around forming the two sides and back, a front control panel, a baffle plate separating the electrical controls section from the heating section, a top and bottom plate, a tubular shell for holding the water tank, and a bottom cover for the tubular shell. There shall be a minimum of one inch spacing between the tubular shell and the U-shaped wrap-around. The top and bottom plate shall be die-cast aluminum with recesses cast in for receiving the U-shaped wrap-around and the center baffle. The top and bottom plates shall have circular opening for receiving the tubular section. The U-shaped wrap around, the tubular shell and the front panel shall be fabricated of corrosion-resistant steel (3.3.2) having a thickness of 0.031 inch (No. 22 USS Gauge). The baffle plate shall be fabricated from cold rolled steel having a thickness of 0.0598 inch (No. 16 Mfrs. Gauge). The bottom cover for the tubular shell shall be fabricated from aluminum having a thickness of 0.025 inch (No. 25 B&S Gauge). The control panel shall be mounted to the wrap-around with a minimum of four corrosion-resistant metal machine screws. The housing shall be furnished with four, rubber covered, metal feet, secured at each corner of the bottom plate.

3.5.3 Water tank and cover. The water tank shall be a deep drawn seamless tank. The tank shall be fabricated from nickel-copper alloy (3.3.1) or corrosion-resistant steel (3.3.2) having a thickness of 0.025 inch (No. 24 USS Gauge). The tank shall have an inside diameter of 6-13/32 ± 1/8 inches and an inside height of 7-5/8 ± 1/8 inches. The tank shall have a rolled bead at the top edge to provide finger grip removal. The tank shall have a telescopic fit with the tubular shell (3.5.2) and shall make contact with the thermostat when placed in position. The bottom of the tank shall be ribbed for reinforcement.

3.5.3.1 Water tank cover. The water tank cover shall be fabricated of the same material and gage thickness as the tank (3.5.3). The cover shall be of the dome shape with a reverse draw to provide a drip ledge inside the tank for the condensate to drip back into the tank, when the cover is in place over the tank. A suitable handle, of the same material, shall be welded to the cover for lifting of the cover.

3.5.4 Heating element. The heating element shall be of the disk type. The element wire shall be nickel-chrome steel imbedded in compressed refractory material and enclosed in a nickel-copper alloy (monel) or AISI type 430 corrosion-resistant steel sheath. The heating element shall have heat-resistant terminals and shall be connected by stranded copper wire with a silicone rubber, glass braid jacket.

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Dimensions are in inches.
Tolerances ± ½ inch.

The illustration shown above is typical for style and design and is not intended to restrict or preclude the purchase of dental curing units which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

FIGURE 1. Curing unit, denture, one stage.

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3.5.5 Thermostat. The thermostat shall be a strut-type construction, not bimetallic, enclosed in a stainless steel case and shall be mounted on the tubular shell with controls extended to the front control panel. The sensor shall contact the tank at all times when the tank is in operating position in the tubular shell. The thermostat shall be readily removable for servicing.

3.5.5.1 Temperature dial. The temperature dial shall be calibrated from 100 degrees Fahrenheit (^{0}F) to boiling and permanently and legibly marked in increments of 20^{0}F. A pointer knob or other suitable means shall be provided to facilitate the selection of the desired temperature level. A reference line, at either extreme end of rotation, shall be provided for aligning the calibrated temperature dial indicator with the thermostat.

3.5.6 Timer. The timer shall consist of a 60 Hertz (Hz), 115 volt, single phase, synchronous motor and the necessary mechanism to turn the heating unit off when the time has elapsed. The range of the timer shall be from 15 minutes to 23 hours. The timer dial shall have a minimum diameter of 1-7/8 inches and permanently and legibly marked in 15 minute intervals. The timer shall be mounted on the baffle plate with a circular window for viewing the dial, and a knob for setting the timer, provided on the front control panel. The timer shall be provided with a screw type terminal block for connection into the circuit.

3.5.7 Power switch. The power switch shall be a double pole, rotary switch, "on-off-on-off", 4 positions per 360^{0}, 90^{0} between positions. The switch shall be rated for 15 amperes at 125 volts, 60 Hertz (Hz). The switch shall be furnished with a knob dial permanently and legibly marked at the four positions. Power shall be supplied to the heating element only when the timer is in operation and the thermostat is calling for heat.

3.5.8 Pilot light. The curing unit shall be equipped with a pilot light which shall indicate continuously when the power switch is turned "ON". The pilot light assembly shall have a non-corrosive plastic shell and shall be supplied with a red plastic lens.

3.5.9 Thermal protection. The curing unit shall be equipped with a thermal protection device that will effectively provide a current interruption in the event that the thermostat malfunctions. The device shall be mounted on the bottom cast cover plate at the center of the controls section, forward of the baffle.

3.5.10 Power cord. The curing unit shall be equipped with a 3-conductor power cord not less than 6 feet in length. The cord shall be No. 16 AWG or No. 18 AWG, type SPT-3 thermoplastic insulated, type HSJ rubber jacketed, or type HSJO rubber jacketed. The cord shall be equipped with a three prong plug suitable for use with receptacles specified in ANSI C73.11. The power cord shall enter the side of the unit through a strain relief fitting. The cord shall be suitably slit back and stripped for attachment of terminals for connection to the power switch and to the timer ground connection.

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3.6 Performance.

3.6.1 Dielectric voltage withstand. The curing unit shall be capable of withstanding without failure the dielectric voltage withstand test specified in UL-1262.

3.6.2 Power cord strain relief. The curing unit power cord shall be capable of withstanding without failure the strain relief test specified in UL-1262.

3.6.3 Operational test. The curing unit shall operate satisfactorily when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.6.4 Heating rate. The heating element shall be capable of providing a uniform water temperature increase of 2-1/2° ± 1/2° F per minute when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.6.5 Temperature control. The thermostat shall be capable of maintaining the temperature of the water within ± 2 percent of the temperature dial setting when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

3.6.6 Thermal protection. The thermal protection device shall interrupt the electrical circuit at 210° ± 10°F when tested as specified in 4.4.5.

3.7 Service data. The contractor shall furnish, with each unit, two copies each of a technical manual which contains complete instructions for installation, operation, and maintenance and lists of component parts. The manual shall comply with the requirements of MIL-M-7298. As soon as practicable after award of the contract or purchase order, the contractor shall furnish to the Contracting Officer two preliminary copies of his proposed technical manual for review and comment by the Directorate of Medical Materiel, Defense Personnel Support Center. The preliminary manuals shall be submitted sufficiently early to permit adequate review by the Directotate of Medical Materiel, Defense Personnel Support Center (based on a maximum period of 30 days for such review) and to allow incorporation by the contractor of any required revisions and corrections in the final manual without delaying delivery under the contract, or purchase order. In addition, the Contractor shall furnish 15 copies of the approved technical manual to the Contracting Officer for distribution. Should the supplier have furnished acceptable manuals for the identical item within two years preceding the date of the contract and propose to furnish manuals identical with those previously accepted, then the requirements for review of drafts and submission of 15 additional copies may be waived upon request to the Contracting Officer. Waiver of submission of drafts and submission of 15 additional copies shall be at the option of the Government.

3.8 Identification marking. Each curing unit shall have a corrosion-resistant metal or pressure sensitive tape nameplate permanently affixed thereto. The plate shall bear the model or style designation, serial number, voltage, wattage, frequency, and the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer. The markings on the plate shall be permanent and legible.

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3.9 Finish. The entire inside and outside surfaces of the water tank and cover, and exposed surfaces of tubular shell, shall be finished with a No. 4 finish, after all surface imperfections have been removed by grinding. As an alternate, the interior surface of the water tank may be electropolished and the outside surface and cover may be a bright polish. The finish shall result in a uniform, bright, shiny surface which is readily cleaned. All other exposed surfaces of the unit shall be finished in accordance with standard commercial practice. All non-corrosion resistant materials shall be suitably treated to resist corrosion.

3.10 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Item shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or may impair its serviceability. All burrs and sharp edges shall be removed from the item.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2.1 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection.
b. Quality conformance inspection.

4.1.2.1.1 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on the curing unit(s) when a first article sample(s) is required (see 3.1). This inspection shall include examination of 4.3 and tests of 4.4.

4.1.2.1.2 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall include the dielectric voltage withstand test of 3.6.1, the examinations specified in 4.3, and the testing specified in 4.4.1 and 4.4.4, and shall apply to those samples selected in accordance with 4.2.1 and 4.2.2. Quality conformance inspection shall be performed by the supplier in accordance with 4.1.

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4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the materials may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the component/ material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and table I. The unit of product for sampling purposes shall be one curing unit.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination:		
Major defect	II	1.0
Minor defect	II	2.5
For dimensional examination	S-2	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one curing unit.

TABLE II. Sampling for tests.

Unit of product	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Curing unit	Dielectric withstand	3.6.1	UL-1262	100%	1/
	Temperature control	3.6.5	4.4.4	S-2	2.5

1/ Any defects shall constitute rejection of the lot.

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4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Curing unit. The curing unit shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in table III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Any component missing or damaged.
102	Design and construction not as specified.
103	Gauge of metal not as specified.
104	Exposed surfaces not smooth or free of sharp edges.
105	Electric cord grounding plug not as specified.
106	Timer dials have incorrect scale graduations.
107	Tank cover does not fit tank.
108	Edges of cover not smooth or rounded.
Minor	
201	Finish not as specified.
202	Finish not free of scratches, chipping or blisters.
203	Identification marking not complete, legible, or permanent.

4.3.2 Dimensional. The curing unit shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within tolerances specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

4.3.3 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the packaging, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Chemical analysis. In the absence of certificates of quality for the raw material, chemical analysis shall be conducted in accordance with method 111 or method 112 of FED-STD-151. In case of dispute, method 111 shall be used for referee analysis.

4.4.2 Operational test. The curing unit shall be given an operational test by turning the power on and setting the thermostat at 200° F. Observe if all components, except thermal protection switch, is functioning properly.

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4.4.3 Heating rate. The following procedure shall be followed: Place a denture flask press with two denture flasks in the tank of the curing unit. Add sufficient water to cover the two flasks. Set the timer to 90 minutes and the thermostat to boiling. Suspend a calibrated immersion type thermometer in the water. Cover the tank with the thermometer protruding thru. Record the temperature of the water. Turn the main power switch on. Monitor the time it takes for the water temperature to reach 200° F. Calculate the heating rate. The curing unit shall meet the requirement of 3.6.4.

4.4.4 Temperature control. The tank shall be filled with water to a depth of 4 ± 1/2 inches. A calibrated immersion type thermometer shall be suspended in the water. The tank shall be covered with the thermometer protruding thru. The thermostat shall be tested at intervals of 20° F starting at 100° F. The water temperature shall be permitted to stabilize. The thermostat setting and thermometer reading shall be recorded at each interval. The temperature control shall meet the requirement of 3.6.5.

4.4.5 Thermal protection. At the completion of the test in 4.4.3, the water shall be removed from the tank leaving 1-1/2 ± 1/2 inches of water at the bottom of the tank. A thermometer or other suitable means of measuring temperature shall be suspended in the controls section in the area of the thermal protection switch. The thermostat shall be shunted out of the circuit. The power shall be turned on and the curing unit permitted to operate without thermostatic control, and the water shall be permitted to evaporate completely. The curing unit shall be permitted to operate until the temperature in the area of the thermal switch reaches 210° ± 10° F. The temperature at which the thermal switch interrupts the circuit shall be recorded.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Each curing unit shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Box shall be designed with suitable interior fittings or shall contain sufficient cushioning material to insure against shifting of, or damage to the contents. Closure of box shall be as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Level C. Curing units shall be individually packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during shipment from supply source to first receiving activity.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Two (2) curing units shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Two (2) curing units shall be packaged in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The packaged curing units shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the applicable carriers rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking. Each unit package and exterior container shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The item covered by this specification is intended for use in dental laboratories for curing dental acrylic resins utilized in the fabrication of dentures and other dental restoration and appliances.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. National Stock Number (NSN).
c. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.1.2.1 and 6.3).

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6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be tested and approved under appropriate provisions of the Armed Services Procurement Regulations. The contract or purchase order specifies the quantity, procedure for delivery and other specific instructions for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 This specification covers the following item listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-00-597-7749	CURING UNIT, DENTURE, ONE STAGE, 115 volt, 60 Hertz.

6.5 The requirements of MIL-C-36437, for Curing Unit, Denture, One Stage, 110 volt, 60 cycle, AC, dated 31 August 1965, have been incorporated in this specification.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activity:
DoD - MB

Preparing activity:
DLA-DM

Project No. 6520-1460

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER (Number) AND TITLE

MIL-C-37790 CURING UNIT, DENTURE, ONE STAGE

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

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